# George Penny

London, UK | +447894240738 | george.penny@live.com | linkedin.com/in/george-penny-11309590 | **https://gsp-cv.streamlit.app**

**Credit Risk | Strategy | Data Science | Applied AI | Decisioning**

Credit risk and decision science leader with 10+ years' experience operating at the intersection of credit risk, data science and commercial decision making. Combines hands-on technical capability in Python, SQL, machine learning and LLM applications with commercial ownership of credit performance and senior stakeholder leadership. Experienced in taking problems from portfolio diagnosis and modelling through to strategy design, implementation, monitoring and executive decision making.

**Core capabilities:** Credit Strategy • Portfolio Optimisation • Decision Science • Credit Modelling • Machine Learning • Automated Decisioning • Experimentation • Python • SQL • LLMs & AI Agents • Executive & Investor Communication

## Professional Experience

### Pliant | Head of Risk Strategy & AI

*April 2025 - Present | London*

Own credit risk strategy, decisioning, analytics and applied AI for a B2B expense management and corporate card platform with €200m of credit exposure. Set the risk analytics strategy, built and hired the company's first dedicated data science capability, and established the technical infrastructure required to support scalable modelling and decisioning.

- **Credit strategy & portfolio ownership:** Own analytical strategy across underwriting and portfolio management, using customer, financial, bureau and behavioural data to identify risk, optimise decisioning and support sustainable portfolio growth.
- **Data science capability:** Established Pliant's risk data science function, identified the requirement, defined the roadmap, hired the initial team and set up the technical environment and AWS services for experimentation, modelling, deployment and monitoring.
- **Automated decisioning:** Designed and implemented a multi source credit decisioning framework combining bureau data, company financials, open banking and internal information. Increased automated onboarding to ~50% of applications, materially improving underwriting capacity and turnaround time while maintaining risk controls.
- **Debt refinancing & investor due diligence:** Acted as credit risk SME during a £100m debt refinancing, presenting portfolio performance, credit strategy, default outcomes and model validation to external investors and supporting due-diligence analysis.
- **AI enabled underwriting:** Designed and built LLM based tooling that gathers external information, evaluates credit evidence and pre populates structured credit assessments, reducing manual research and enabling underwriters to start from an evidence backed recommendation.

### Stenn | Risk and Operations Lead

*June 2024 - December 2024* | London*

**Role concluded following company administration*

Led risk and operations initiatives within Product & Technology, reporting to the VP of Data and working closely with executive leadership on automation, operating strategy and business performance.

- **Automated decisioning:** Spearheaded the design and implementation of a decision engine that automated 7% of financing requests, representing approximately $1m in monthly revenue and creating a scalable framework for growth.
- **Company OKRs:** Worked with the COO and functional leaders to define measurable company wide OKRs, track delivery and communicate progress through leadership reviews and town halls.
- **Risk governance:** Established and chaired the monthly Risk Committee and business performance reviews, aligning senior stakeholders on portfolio trends, strategic priorities and key initiatives.

### Klarna | Senior Credit Risk Analyst

*November 2021 - May 2024 | Berlin & London*

Joined Klarna's Credit Risk Decisioning team, responsible for underwriting and portfolio performance across the Nordics, DACH, Netherlands and Belgium, covering approximately €2.7bn of monthly GMV.

- **Portfolio & credit strategy:** Led analysis of underwriting inefficiencies and delivered policy rule changes, limit adjustments and new credit models to improve loss performance and support annual business targets. Initiatives helped reduce losses by more than 20%.
- **Experimentation and bureau strategy:** Introduced champion–challenger and A/B testing approaches for third-party data. Designed a German bureau sequencing experiment that improved approval and loss outcomes while generating ~£150k in monthly bureau savings.

- **Swiss market launch:** Designed the initial go to market credit strategy for Switzerland, receiving an Employee of the Month nomination for the project.
- **Portfolio monitoring:** Developed management information dashboards and established bi-weekly reviews of market, merchant and product performance with cross functional stakeholders.

### Equifax | Senior Credit Risk Analyst

*May 2018 - October 2021 | London*

Delivered bespoke analytics, modelling and credit risk solutions to banks and financial institutions across the credit lifecycle.

- **Single Customer View:** Developed a solution to identify the same customer across multiple portfolios, supporting customer aggregation and FSCS-related requirements. The solution initially generated approximately £40k in monthly revenue and led to an Employee of the Month award.
- **Credit risk modelling:** Built analytical samples and developed application scorecards using logistic regression, weight of evidence, information value and model-performance testing for banking and financial-institution clients, including a thin-file strategy for a start-up bank.
- **Creditworthiness Assessment Bill:** Provided evidence supporting Lord Bird's proposal to include rental data in credit assessments and received the London Employee of the Month award within the first three months.

### AXA | Data Analyst

*September 2015 - May 2018 | London*

Built and maintained reporting infrastructure and analytical solutions to support data driven decision making.

- **Data infrastructure:** Used SAS, SQL and VBA to maintain complex data warehouses and deliver reliable datasets for internal teams and external clients.
- **Reporting and dashboards:** Designed KPI reporting and visual dashboards using Tableau and Power BI to improve performance monitoring across teams.

## Personal Engineering & AI Projects

- **AI Meeting Copilot:** Built a real-time AI meeting assistant using React/TypeScript, Python/FastAPI, WebSockets and LLM APIs, processing live conversation context to extract claims and observations and generate structured, context aware recommendations and actions.
- **Personal RAG chatbot (https://gsp-cv.streamlit.app/):** Built and deployed a RAG application enabling natural-language exploration of professional experience, projects and technical work across a private knowledge base.
- **Full stack messaging application:** Built a React application with REST APIs, authentication, persistent conversations and real time messaging.

## Education

**University of Sussex** | BSc Mathematics, First-Class Honours | 2012 - 2015
**A Levels:** Further Mathematics (A), Economics (A), Psychology (B)

## Skills and Qualifications

**Credit Risk & Decisioning:** Credit strategy, underwriting, portfolio optimisation, automated decisioning, credit policy, application scorecards, credit-limit strategy, risk appetite, portfolio monitoring, early-warning systems, ECL, provisioning and model validation.
**Modelling and Machine Learning:** Logistic regression, gradient boosting, XGBoost, weight of evidence, information value, feature engineering, model calibration, SHAP and explainability.
**Model Validation & Monitoring:** AUC/Gini, KS, PSI, calibration, stability analysis, back-testing, model validation and performance monitoring
**Experimentation & Optimisation:** Champion challenger testing, A/B experiments, randomised treatments, controlled rollouts, strategy optimisation and outcome evaluation
**Technology & AI:** Python, SQL, Git, REST APIs, LLM APIs, RAG, AI agents, prompt engineering, OCR/document intelligence, FastAPI, React/TypeScript; prior experience with SAS and R
**Leadership and Governance:** Team building and hiring, credit committees, investor due diligence, executive communication, cross-functional leadership, model governance and strategic planning
**Personal Development:** Udemy**;** Complete AI Engineering | Score Plus; Building Better Scorecards | Impact Factory; Presentation Skills